

03 APRIL 2026

THIS IS THE MILITARY SEALIFT COMMAND NORFOLK, STRATEGIC SEALIFT PROGRAM SUPPORT OFFICE, N103A

SOURCE SOUGHT NOTIFICATION NO. N32205-SS-PM4-26-086

SUBJECT: TUGCON; OPEN-OCEAN TOW MISSION

1. THIS IS MARKET RESEARCH CONDUCTED BY THE PM4 PROGRAM OFFICE OF MSC. IT IS A REQUEST FOR INFORMATION ONLY, AND YOUR RESPONSE WILL NOT BE CONSIDERED AN OFFER. THIS REQUEST FOR INFORMATION DOES NOT COMMIT THE GOVERNMENT TO PAY ANY COSTS INCURRED IN THE PREPARATION OR SUBMISSION TO THIS MARKET SURVEY OR TO CONTRACT FOR SERVICES.

2. MSC REQUESTS INFORMATION ABOUT THE PRICE AND AVAILABILITY OF A U.S. FLAG, JONES ACT, OCEAN-GOING CERTIFIED TUG CAPABLE OF TOWING FLAT BARGES YC 1684 & 1685 "IAW THE U.S. NAVY TOW MANUAL (SL740-AA-MAN-010)." THE REQUIREMENT IS FOR ONE VOYAGE.

3. DESCRIPTION OF THE TOW:

- LENGTH – 110'
- BEAM – 34'
- MAX DRAFT – 11' 3"

4. PORT(S)/PLACE(S) OF DEPARTURE: INACTSHIPS PHILADELPHIA, PA

5. LAYTIME: FOUR (4) DAYS FOR THE ENTIRE MISSION.

6. PORT(S)/PLACE(S) OF DESTINATION: PORTSMOUTH NAVAL SHIPYARD SEAVEY ISLAND KITTEERY, MAINE

7. LAYDAYS: COMMENCING/CANCELLING: 01 JUNE 2026

8. TUG REQUIREMENTS:

- VESSEL/TUG SHALL BE BUILT IN 1970 OR LATER.
- BOLLARD PULL: SUFFICIENT TO TOW YC BARGES 1684 & 1685 AT A MINIMUM TOW SPEED OF SIX (6) KNOTS FOR FIVE (5) KNOT SOA. MAXIMUM TOW SPEED TO BE CALCULATED IAW THE U.S. NAVY TOW MANUAL.
- TUG SHALL BE FULLY BUNKERED FOR THE VOYAGE.
- TUG SHALL HAVE SUFFICIENT ENDURANCE TO COMPLETE MISSION WITHOUT STOPS FOR FUEL OR SUPPLIES.
- INTERNET AND SATELLITE PHONE CAPABILITY.
- U.S. NAVY TOWING MANUAL (SL740-AA-MAN-10) WILL BE USED AND COMPLIED WITH FOR THIS REQUIREMENT. THE LINK FOR DOWNLOAD IS: [HTTP://WWW.NAVSEA.NAVY.MIL/HOME/SUPSALV/00C2-SALVAGE-PUBLICATIONS/](http://www.navsea.navy.mil/home/supsalv/00C2-SALVAGE-PUBLICATIONS/).

- THERE WILL BE A PRE-TOW CONFERENCE AT INACTSHIPS PHILADELPHIA, PA PRIOR TO TOWING THE VESSEL. THE TIME OF THIS MEETING WILL BE MUTUALLY AGREED UPON BY MSC AND CONTRACTOR BUT SHOULD OCCUR NOT LATER THAN 24 HOURS BEFORE TOW. REQUIRED ATTENDEES INCLUDE TUG CAPTAIN/CONTRACTOR REPRESENTATIVE, MSC REPRESENTATIVE(S), A REPRESENTATIVE FROM THE YC BARGES AND THE IMS.
- CONTRACTOR SHALL OBTAIN THE SERVICES OF AN INDEPENDENT MARINE SURVEYOR (IMS). THIS SERVICE SHOULD BE INCLUDED IN THE OFFER'S LUMP-SUM PRICE. THE IMS IS AN INDEPENDENT THIRD PARTY TO ACT AS A MEDIATOR BETWEEN THE NAVY AND THE CONTRACTOR TO PROVIDE INDEPENDENT ANALYSIS OF THE OPERATIONS AND TO ASSIST IN SETTLING DISAGREEMENTS. THE IMS SELECTED SHOULD BE PROPOSED BY THE TOWING CONTRACTOR AND AGREED TO BY THE MSC TECHNICAL REPRESENTATIVE. IMS DUTIES SHALL INCLUDE THE FOLLOWING, BUT ARE NOT LIMITED TO:
 - PERFORM DETAILED TECHNICAL EVALUATION AND OVERSIGHT AS NECESSARY, TO ENSURE THE TUG AND YC BARGES ARE PREPARED AND RIGGED FOR TOW IAW THE U.S. NAVY TOWING MANUAL, AS APPLICABLE.
 - TECHNICAL EVALUATIONS SHALL INCLUDE A REVIEW OF THE FOLLOWING, BUT NOT LIMITED TO:
 - CONTRACTOR PREPARED TOW PACKAGE.
 - PRE-TOW CHECKLIST TO INCLUDE ITEMS SUCH AS VERIFYING THE CONDITION OF THE YC BARGES AS BEING SEAWORTHY OF THE TOW.
 - MATERIAL CONDITION OF THE TUG AND YC BARGES.
 - PREPARATIONS OF THE TUG AND YC BARGES.
 - INSPECTION OF ALL MATERIAL, EQUIPMENT, HARDWARE, LINES, AND REQUIRED CERTIFICATES.
 - COMPLETED U.S. NAVY TOWING MANUAL APPENDIX H.
 - ISSUE A TOWING CERTIFICATE WHEN THE TUG AND YC BARGES ARE SAFELY RIGGED FOR TOW.
- CONTRACTOR MUST PROVIDE TOW BRIDLE AND HARDWARE, EMERGENCY TOW LINES, FLOODING ALARMS, NAVIGATION LIGHTS, DAY SHAPES IAW THE COLREGS RULES OF THE ROAD, AND NONDESTRUCTIVE TESTING (NDT) OF VESSEL DECK FITTINGS.
- CONTRACTOR MUST PREPARE AND SUBMIT A COMPREHENSIVE TOWING PACKAGE FOR REVIEW AND APPROVAL PRIOR TO COMMENCEMENT OF TOW. THIS PACKAGE INCLUDES, BUT IS NOT LIMITED TO:
 - A COMPLETED APPENDIX H FROM THE US NAVY TOWING MANUAL WITH ASSOCIATED DETAIL
 - STEADY STATE TOW LINE TENSION CALCULATIONS OVER THE SPECTRUM OF ANTICIPATED WEATHER CONDITIONS ALONG THE TOW ROUTE
 - SPEEDS OF ADVANCE (SOA)
 - WEATHER CONDITIONS AND LIMITS

- A SKETCH OF THE TOW CONFIGURATION WHICH IDENTIFIES ALL COMPONENTS IN THE TOW RIG FROM THE TOW MACHINE ON THE TUG TO THE PAD EYES ON TOW (THIS INCLUDES TOW WIRE, CONNECTING SHACKLES, CHAIN INSPECTIONS, AND PAD EYE NDT (NON-DESTRUCTIVE TESTING) INSPECTION PAPERWORK.
- DOCUMENTATION OF PEDIGREE, TESTING, OR STAMPING FOR THE INDIVIDUAL JEWELRY COMPONENTS TO ASSIST IN IDENTIFYING THE WEAKEST LINK AND TO FACILITATE FORENSIC ANALYSIS IN THE EVENT OF A FAILURE, AND TRACKING OF FAILURE TRENDS.
- TUG SPECIFICATIONS TO INCLUDE HULL AND TOW MACHINERY CERTIFICATIONS, BOLLARD PULL, TOW WIRE CERTIFICATIONS, AND THE MASTER'S TOWING ENDORSEMENT.
- ROUTE PLANNING AND IDENTIFICATION OF PORTS OF REFUGE INCLUDING ASSOCIATED RESTRICTIONS FOR ENTRY AS STATED BY THE CAPTAIN OF THE PORT.
- THE COMPLETED TOW PACKAGE MUST BE SENT TO NAVSEA AND MSC REPRESENTATIVES FOR APPROVAL PRIOR TO TOW.
- LUMP SUM AMOUNT SHALL INCLUDE UP TO FOUR (4) DAYS OF LAYTIME
- POSITION REPORTS. POSITION REPORTS SHALL BE ISSUED BY ELECTRONIC MAIL: VESSEL SHALL PROVIDE POSITION/STATUS REPORT IN PORT TWICE DAILY AT 0000Z AND 1200Z AND AT-SEA FOUR TIMES DAILY AT 0000Z, 0600Z, 1200Z, AND 1800Z. ADDITIONALLY, POSITION/STATUS REPORTS SHALL BE SENT UPON DEPARTURE AND ARRIVAL, AND AT OTHER TIMES REQUESTED BY THE APPLICABLE MSC AREA COMMAND FOR FORCE PROTECTION REASONS. REPORTS SHALL BE SENT TO THE EMAIL ADDRESSES THAT WILL BE PROVIDED AFTER THE CONTRACT AWARD.

9. INTERESTED PARTIES ARE REQUESTED TO PROVIDE THE FOLLOWING INFORMATION:

- A. NAME AND COMPLETE DESCRIPTION/CHARACTERISTICS OF THE TOW VESSEL INCLUDING CERTIFICATE OF INSPECTION (COI), CERTIFICATE OF DOCUMENTATION (COD) OR CLASSIFICATION SOCIETY EQUIVALENT, PHOTOS, AND ALL DELIVERABLES AS PER MSC TUGCON PROFORMA (TUGCON 2026 (02-26)).
- B. LUMPSUM (INCLUDE UP TO 4 DAYS AT DESTINATION SITE FOR CUSTOMS/DELIVERY) AND DEMURRAGE RATE.
- C. ITINERARY, NUMBER OF DAYS REQUIRED TO COMPLETE THE TOW MISSION.
- D. BUSINESS SIZE. IF OTHER THAN SMALL BUSINESS, PROVIDE A NARRATIVE OF SUB-CONTRACTING POSSIBILITIES ENVISIONED, IF ANY. IF NONE, PROVIDE AN EXPLANATION.
- E. CONFIRMATION OF AVAILABILITY TO MEET LAYDAY.
- F. ANY OTHER PERTINENT QUESTIONS OR COMMENTS INCLUDING 46 CFR, CHAPTER 1, SUBCHAPTER M - TOWING VESSELS.

10. THE FEDERAL ACQUISITION REGULATION 19.103 ESTABLISHES THE SMALL BUSINESS SIZE STANDARD FOR THIS TYPE OF WATER TRANSPORTATION SERVICE AS NAICS “483111” WITH A SMALL BUSINESS SIZE LIMITATION OF 1,050 EMPLOYEES. PLEASE INDICATE IF BUSINESS IS A SMALL BUSINESS CONCERN.

11. RESPONSES ARE REQUESTED, VIA EMAIL, PRIOR TO 1100 HOURS, EASTERN TIME, 10 APRIL 2026. THE POINT OF CONTACT MATTHEW PRICE, EMAIL MATTHEW.R.PRICE40.CIV@US.NAVY.MIL, OR TEL (564) 230-3782.

SIGNED: DANNY DAVIS, CONTRACTING OFFICER, MSC, N103